

KEEP THIS ONE; IT'S BUILT TO LIVE INSIDE YOUR PLAN BOOK

AI for Planning & Differentiation

THE WORKFLOW

Draft · Options · Pick · Review

AI drafts, the teacher decides. Never from scratch again.

The four differentiation moves

Move	What it does	When to reach for it
Level it	One passage → multiple reading levels	Any shared text with a wide-reading-range class
Scaffold it	Sentence starters, word banks, worked examples, organizer text	Same task, same target, more handholds
Stretch it	Depth prompts for students who've mastered it	Early finishers; advanced learners (never more worksheets)
Reformat it	Same content as stations, discussion cards, practice sets	UDL: multiple means of engagement and expression

Copy-ready prompts (adapt the brackets)

Level it

"You are a reading specialist. Rewrite the passage below at three levels: on-grade for [grade], about two years below, and about two years above. Keep every key idea, the section headings, and the same core vocabulary. Lower level: sentences under 12 words plus a 5-word vocabulary box with student-friendly definitions. Higher level: raise the complexity of the reasoning, not just the vocabulary. Label each version." [paste passage]

Scaffold it

"For the task below, create: five sentence starters, one per paragraph; a 10-word word bank with student-friendly definitions; and one fully worked example on a *different* topic, so students see the shape without copying the content." [paste task]

Stretch it

"Create three extension prompts for students who have mastered the task below. Go deeper, not longer: apply the concept to an unfamiliar context; critique a flawed example; explain the idea to a younger student. No additional practice problems." [paste task]

Reformat it

"Turn the content below into three formats: four station-activity direction sets, eight discussion cards (one question per card), and a 10-item practice set ramping from recall to application. Same concepts in all three; label everything." [paste content]

Check the level, don't trust the label

The AI will stamp "3rd grade level" on anything. Readability is a real, measurable property of text (that's the point of the CommonLit CLEAR corpus research), so verify it, fast:

- 1 · **Read a paragraph aloud.** Your ear knows your grade level.
- 2 · **Eyeball sentence length.** An "easier" version with 25-word sentences isn't easier.
- 3 · **Try it on one student tomorrow.** Watch where they stumble; that's the real test.

The 4-point review (before anything reaches a student)

Check	Ask yourself
1 · Accurate?	Facts, examples, and any named resources verified. (A published study caught ChatGPT inventing a resource in a lesson plan; assume it can happen to you.)
2 · At level, actually?	Ran the quick level checks; didn't trust the label.
3 · Fits your students?	Examples and contexts swapped for ones your class will recognize. The AI wrote for a generic room; you don't teach one.
4 · Sounds like you?	Directions read like your directions. If not: "warmer," "plainer," "shorter."

The habit that makes it compound

One differentiated artifact per week. Not a differentiated everything; one lesson a week gets the full treatment (core, support, extension, review). Fifteen weeks in, fifteen lessons deep. Working prompts go in the staff prompt doc so nobody rebuilds what a colleague already perfected.

What AI can't do here

- **It doesn't know your kids.** It has never met the reader who shuts down or the one who's two grades ahead. Picking and adapting is yours.
- **Leveled $\neq$ verified.** The label is a guess until you check it.
- **It can invent things.** Activities that don't quite work, resources that don't exist. Review is where your expertise enters the document.

The permanent rules ride along: no student personally identifiable information in public AI tools, ever; describe needs, not names. And a human reviews everything before it reaches a student or family.

My lab artifact (lesson, moves used, what the review caught)

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